PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, August 19, 2025

School Board Retreat

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a School Board Retreat of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Lincoln High School, 1750 SW Salmon St., Portland, OR 97205 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:
Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia La Forte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan

Absent:
Student Representative Ian Ritorto

Attendees:
Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong – Superintendent
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant, Board Clerk
Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff
Rosanne Powell – Senior Board Manager
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer

Presenters:
Barbara Jenkins – Council of the Great City Schools
Dr. Shawn Joseph – TTI

Purpose & Introduction of Facilitator, Norms & Ice Breaker

The meeting was called to order at 1:08 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Chair Wang introduced the meeting facilitator Barbara Jenkins. Ms. Jenkins shared meeting norms, and attendees participated in an ice breaker activity.

TTI Assessments Review

Time: 1:30 pm

Dr. Shawn Joseph introduced himself and presented the TTI assessment results, highlighting the balance of personality styles among Board Members, their strengths, and how these traits influence their work together. He emphasized the importance of clearly defining success at the outset of major initiatives, maintaining focus to avoid initiative overload, and holding regular check-ins on progress. Recommendations included identifying a few high-level goals, establishing timelines and outcomes, and using public dashboards for accountability. The Board discussed the assessment results, including managing workload and avoiding staff and superintendent burnout.

Governance

Time: 2:22 pm

Chair Wang summarized the purpose of the meeting. Ms. Jenkins provided an overview of the governance relationship, highlighting which responsibilities fall under the Board's work versus the Superintendent's. Attendees then reviewed and discussed a Harvard case study, analyzed behaviors and suggested ways the situation could have been handled more effectively.

Break: 3:19pm - 3:29pm

Ms. Jenkins provided an overview of Board best practices based on research, emphasizing the importance of coherence, including a shared vision. Attendees reviewed the National School Board Association's Effective School Boards guidelines and participated in a group activity to highlight key takeaways and identify areas where the PPS Board excels and faces challenges.

Chief Legal Officer Sharon Toncray reviewed the Board's legal duties, covering key rules, including serial meetings and the role of committees. Discussion focused on serial meeting laws, public comment at committees, how agenda items are added, the Board's Protocols, and meeting materials timelines. A request was made to include a discussion of public comment at committee meetings in a future Board meeting.

Communications

Attendees participated in an activity regarding protocols for communication, noting what communication protocols they would like to start and stop on a sticky note and then took time to read what others wrote.

Additional Protocols

Superintendent Armstrong provided an overview of the Portland Public Schools Vision and Strategic Plan. She noted that a Continuous Improvement Plan is already in place with four major goals focusing on attendance, literacy, math, and 9th grade success. Planning is underway for the development of the district's 2030 Strategic Plan.

Chair Wang reviewed past practices for the superintendent evaluation and potential approaches for the future. Discussion included the evaluation tool options and required timelines outlined in the superintendent's contract. The superintendent noted that she would appreciate clarity on her evaluation criteria.

It was noted that the board has not conducted a self-evaluation in recent years but that there is interest in completing one in the near future, potentially using the Oregon School Board Association (OSBA) template.

Debrief and Next Steps

Board Members reflected on the day by sharing pluses and deltas.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 6:08 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools
